

Ho Fung Tsoi

Postdoctoral Researcher

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Research Interests

Experimental particle physics: new physics searches (SUSY, exotic Higgs) and trigger system at the CERN LHC

Machine learning: self-supervised pre-training methods, anomaly detection, symbolic regression

Fast FPGA inference: low-latency (sub-microsecond) machine learning algorithms on FPGAs

Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison, Ph.D. Physics 2024

Thesis: [Search for exotic Higgs boson decays with CMS and fast machine learning solutions for the LHC](#)

Advisor: Sridhara Dasu

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, B.Sc. Physics 2018

Thesis: First passage time problem of the time-dependent Ornstein-Uhlenbeck process

Advisor: Chi-Fai Lo

Visiting student at University of California Berkeley & Berkeley Lab (Jan – Aug 2017)

Professional Experience

Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Pennsylvania (Supervisor: Dylan Rankin) 2024 – Present

Awards and Honors

CERN, [CMS PhD Thesis Award](#) 2024

UWisconsin, Cornelius P. and Cynthia C. Browne Fellowship 2024

CUHK, CN Yang Scholarship 2017

CUHK, Wei Lun Foundation Exchange Scholarship 2017

CUHK, Professor Dennis Yam Kuen Lo Physics Award 2016

Selected Research Experience

New Physics Search at the LHC

- ATLAS Run 3 search for electroweak production of supersymmetric particles in compressed mass spectra with low-momentum tracks (2026–Present).
- CMS Run 2 search for exotic Higgs boson decays into pseudoscalars in the final state of two b quarks and two τ leptons, and of the combination with the $\mu\mu b\bar{b}$ final state [4] (2020–2024).

Novel ML Algorithms for Particle Physics

- Self-supervised pretraining methods for jet tagging [13], anomaly detection, and mass regression (2025–Present).
- Symbolic regression for automating parametric modeling of binned distributions in LHC physics analyses [6] (2024–2025).

Low-Latency (Sub-Microsecond) ML Algorithms on FPGAs

- Neuromorphic spiking neural networks (SNNs) for dN/dx clustering counting in drift chambers [11] (2025–Present).
- Sparse CNNs for spatially sparse image data on FPGAs [8] (2024–Present).
- Compression of neural networks using symbolic regression for fast inference [3,5] (2022–2024).

Trigger System at the LHC

- Commissioning the GNN-based tau trigger (GNTau) at the ATLAS High-Level Trigger for Run 3 [9] (2024–Present).
- Development of the CICADA anomaly detection trigger algorithm at the CMS Level-1 Trigger [10] (2022–2024).

- Development of the Data Quality Monitoring (DQM) software for the Calorimeter Layer-1 subsystem at the CMS Level-1 Trigger (2020–2024).
- HL-LHC trigger sensitivity projection for the CMS searches for exotic Higgs boson decays [1] (2020–2021).

Selected Publications

Listed below are selected publications, conference proceedings, and technical reports to which I was a primary author (*: refereed). I also co-authored papers by [CMS](#) and [ATLAS](#) as a collaboration member. For the complete list see [INSPIRE](#). Preprints at [arXiv](#).

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| [13] | jBOT: Semantic Jet Representation Clustering Emerges from Self-Distillation
Ho Fung Tsoi, Dylan Rankin
submitted to <i>SciPost Phys.</i> [arXiv:2601.11719] | 2026 |
| [12] | SparsePixels+ ++: Scalable Sparse Convolution on FPGAs
Ho Fung Tsoi, Dylan Rankin, Philip Harris
<i>manuscript in preparation</i> | 2026 |
| [11] | SpikePID: Neuromorphic Cluster Counting in Future Drift Chambers
Ho Fung Tsoi, Kam Wai Lai, Dylan Rankin
<i>manuscript in preparation</i> | 2026 |
| [10] | Anomaly Detection in the CMS Level-1 Trigger in Run 3
CMS Collaboration
<i>manuscript in preparation</i> | 2026 |
| [9] | Performance of the ATLAS Tau Trigger in Run 3
ATLAS Collaboration
<i>manuscript in preparation.</i> | 2026 |
| [8] | SparsePixels: Efficient Convolution for Sparse Data on FPGAs
Ho Fung Tsoi, Dylan Rankin, Vladimir Loncar, Philip Harris
submitted to <i>Mach. Learn.: Sci. Technol.</i> [arXiv:2512.06208] | 2025 |
| [7*] | hls4ml: A Flexible, Open-Source Platform for Deep Learning Acceleration on Reconfigurable Hardware
Jan-Frederik Schulte et al.
<i>ACM Trans. Reconf. Tech. Syst.</i> 19 , 2 (2026) [arXiv:2512.01463] | 2025 |
| [6*] | SymbolFit: Automatic Parametric Modeling with Symbolic Regression
Ho Fung Tsoi, Dylan Rankin, Cecile Caillol, Miles Cranmer, Sridhara Dasu, Javier Duarte, Philip Harris, Elliot Lipeles, Vladimir Loncar
<i>Comput Softw Big Sci</i> 9 , 12 (2025) [arXiv:2411.09851] | 2024 |
| [5*] | SymbolNet: Neural Symbolic Regression with Adaptive Dynamic Pruning for Compression
Ho Fung Tsoi, Vladimir Loncar, Sridhara Dasu, Philip Harris
<i>Mach. Learn.: Sci. Technol.</i> 6 , 015021 (2025) [arXiv:2401.09949] | 2024 |
| [4*] | Search for Exotic Decays of the Higgs Boson to a Pair of Pseudoscalars in the $\mu\mu b\bar{b}$ and $\tau\tau b\bar{b}$ Final States
CMS Collaboration
<i>Eur. Phys. J. C</i> 84 , 493 (2024) [arXiv:2402.13358] | 2024 |
| [3*] | Symbolic Regression on FPGAs for Fast Machine Learning Inference
Ho Fung Tsoi, Adrian Alan Pol, Vladimir Loncar, Ekaterina Govorkova, Miles Cranmer, Sridhara Dasu, Peter Elmer, Philip Harris, Isobel Ojalvo, Maurizio Pierini
<i>EPJ Web of Conferences</i> 295 , 09036 (2024) [arXiv:2305.04099] | 2023 |
| [2] | Searches for exotic Higgs boson decays with the CMS experiment
Ho Fung Tsoi
Proceedings of the European Physical Society Conference on High Energy Physics (PoS EPS-HEP2023 402) | 2023 |
| [1] | The Phase-2 Upgrade of the CMS Data Acquisition and High Level Trigger
CMS Collaboration
CMS Technical Design Report (2021) , CERN-LHCC-2021-007, CMS-TDR-022 | 2021 |

Conference, Workshop, Seminar Talks

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| [11] | TREASURE: Tokenizing HEP Collider Data for AI Discovery — BNL, USA
Self-Supervised Learning: Machine Can Learn a Lot by Just Observing | Apr 2026 |
| [10] | Coordinating Panel on Advanced Detectors (CPAD) — UPenn, USA
SparsePixels: Efficient Convolution for Sparse Data on FPGAs | Oct 2025 |
| [9] | 2024 CMS Thesis Award Ceremony Talk (CMS Week) — CERN, Switzerland
Search for Exotic Higgs Boson Decays with CMS and Fast Machine Learning Solutions for the LHC | Oct 2025 |
| [8] | Fast Machine Learning for Science Conference (FastML) — ETH Zurich, Switzerland
SparsePixels: Efficient Convolution for Sparse Data on FPGAs | Sep 2025 |
| [7] | High-energy physics seminar — UPenn; U.Washington; Fermilab, USA
Search for Exotic Higgs Boson Decays with CMS and Fast Machine Learning Solutions for the LHC | 2023, 2024 |
| [6] | US LHC Users Association Meeting (US LUA) — Fermilab, USA
CICADA: Anomaly Detection for New Physics Searches at the CMS Level-1 Trigger | Dec 2023 |
| [5] | Machine Learning at Level-1 Trigger Workshop (ML@L1) — CERN, Switzerland
Anomaly Detection – CICADA: Status, Plans, and Prospects for Phase-2 | Dec 2023 |
| [4] | CMS Machine Learning Town Hall — CERN, Switzerland
L1 Anomaly Detection with Calorimeter Inputs: Status and Opportunities | Sep 2023 |
| [3] | European Physical Society Conference on High Energy Physics (EPS-HEP) — Hamburg, Germany
Searches for exotic Higgs boson decays with the CMS experiment | Aug 2023 |
| [2] | International Conference on Computing in High Energy & Nuclear Physics (CHEP) — Norfolk VA, USA
Symbolic Regression on FPGAs for Fast Machine Learning Inference | May 2023 |
| [1] | International Conference on Applied Mathematics — CityU, Hong Kong
First Passage Time Problem of the Time-Dependent Ornstein-Uhlenbeck Process: a Model for Stochastic Decision-Making Process | May 2016 |

Professional Service

Membership

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| • Member, ATLAS Collaboration , CERN | 2024 – Present |
| • Affiliated member, Accelerated AI Algorithms for Data-Driven Discovery (A3D3) Institute | 2024 – Present |
| • Member, CMS Collaboration , CERN | 2020 – 2024 |

Collaboration Role

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| • Co-convener , SUSY Monte Carlo & Interpretation subgroup [CMS] | 2023 – 2024 |
| • Contact person , Higgs boson Monte Carlo group [CMS] | 2021 – 2023 |
| • Software developer , Data Quality Monitoring system for CaloLayer-1 trigger [CMS] | 2020 – 2024 |

Journal Referee

Transactions on Machine Learning Research (2026); *IEEE Transactions on Evolutionary Computation* (2026); *Wiley Advanced Theory and Simulations* (2025).

Teaching and Mentoring

Teaching

- Guest lecturer [UPenn], Data Analysis for the Natural Sciences II: Machine Learning (PHYS 3359, Spring 2025)
- Teaching assistant [U.Wisconsin], undergraduate physics courses (Fall 2018 – Spring 2020)

Master students

- Kam Wai Lai [UPenn]: Spiking neural network on FPGAs for cluster counting in drift chambers (2025–2026)
- Yuyan Wang [UPenn]: Joint-Embedding Predictive Architecture (JEPAs) for jet anomaly detection (2025–2026)

Undergraduate students

- Chenjia Ni [UPenn]: Lorentz-equivariant architecture on FPGAs (2026–Present)
- Abhay Agarwal [UPenn]: Scalable sparse convolution on FPGAs (2026–Present)
- Alex Yang [UPenn]: Mass regression of supersymmetric particles with contrastive learning (2025)
- Ashni Kumar [Drexel]: Acceleration of reinforcement learning agent inference on FPGAs for astronomical observations (2025)